UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR
W. N. DOAK, Secretary
CHILDREN'S BUREAU
GRACE ABBOTT, Chief

TWENTIETH ANNUAL REPORT OF THE CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU TO THE SECRETARY OF LABOR

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TWENTIETH ANNUAL REPORT

OF THE

CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR,
CHILDREN'S BUREAU,
Washington, September 15, 1932.

Hon. W. N. DOAK,
Secretary of Labor.

SIR: I have the honor to transmit herewith the twentieth annual report of the Children's Bureau for the fiscal year July 1, 1931, to June 30, 1932.

In the Children's Bureau, as in every social-welfare agency in the country, the regular work has been interrupted because of special undertakings which the industrial depression and the attendant widespread unemployment have rendered necessary. The staff of the Children's Bureau has worked overtime to make promptly available statistical reports which were requested by the President's Organization on Unemployment Relief and by national and local relief agencies, in the preparation of special educational material on child feeding, in assisting in the organization of relief in areas of extreme depression, and in special surveys of developing problems. At the same time the bureau has continued its scientific studies and popular education in the fields of child health, child labor, recreation, dependency, and delinquency. A very brief summary of these activities during the year ended June 30, 1932, follows:

UNEMPLOYMENT AND CHILD WELFARE

Family-relief expenditures.

In September, 1930, at the request of the President's Emergency Committee for Employment, the bureau began to furnish that organization and other national agencies concerned with the problem with monthly relief reports, collected by mail and telegraph from social agencies in cities of 50,000 and more. This work was made possible through the assistance of community chests and councils in the 38 metropolitan areas [1] which had been cooperating with the bureau by furnishing monthly reports of current social statistics in some 22 fields, through the aid of family-welfare societies and agencies serving the transient and homeless, and through the Russell Sage Foundation, which for several years had been assembling statistics on relief in a number of cities not included in the bureau's registration area. The reporting was continued and expanded during the fiscal year

[1] Forty-one are now cooperating. See p. 24.

1932, because of its importance in National, State, and local planning for unemployment relief.

The Children's Bureau and the Russell Sage Foundation also cooperated with the Bureau of the Census in a survey of the amount of relief expenditures and numbers of families and of individuals aided in the first quarter of 1931 as compared with the first quarter of 1929. Figures for cities reporting to the Children's Bureau or the Russell Sage Foundation were supplied to the Bureau of the Census by the two organizations. The report, published by the Bureau of the Census under the title "Relief Expenditures by Governmental and Private Organizations, 1929 and 1931," covered both urban and rural areas. As the Bureau of the Census has not collected subsequent figures, the Children's Bureau is now the only Federal agency compiling reports relating to unemployment relief.

In January, 1932, with the approval of the bureau's advisory committee on social statistics, an agreement was reached for the combination of the reports being collected by the Russell Sage Foundation and the Children's Bureau into one for which the Children's Bureau would assume responsibility. In order that the experience of the Russell Sage Foundation might be fully utilized under the new plan, the director of the foundation's department of statistics was appointed as consultant in social statistics to the Children's Bureau, and a staff member of the Russell Sage Foundation joined the staff of the Children's Bureau for a period of six months while the series were being consolidated.

Since January, 1932, monthly bulletins have been issued by the Children's Bureau in planographed form showing trends in relief expenditures and number of families aided, and meals and lodgings for transient and homeless persons, in 136 cities of 50,000 and more. More than a thousand agencies or divisions of agencies have been cooperating in the project. Reports for January, February, and March were issued before the close of the fiscal year, and the April report was issued July 11. Hereafter it is hoped that each report can be issued within six weeks after the close of the month to which the figures relate. A semiannual bulletin giving more detailed figures for individual cities, especially with reference to types of relief, is planned.

The reports secured in the manner described show that from September, 1931, there was a continuous rise in relief expenditures for seven months. The peak was reached in March, 1932, when expenditures were higher than for any previous month during the period of the depression. For that month an expenditure of $28,274,678 was reported for 124 cities, which include 56 per cent of the urban population and 31 per cent of the total population of the United States. Approximately 1,000,000 families were on the relief rolls in these 124 cities at that time. In April there was a seasonal reduction of 16 per cent, and in May a further reduction of 6 per cent, but between May and June, 1932, the decline was only 1 per cent. The amount of relief reported by 126 cities in June was $22,960,285. Between March and April curtailment of relief was reported by every kind of relief agency except the emergency committees and the public departments administering aid for the blind and the aged. Public agencies providing work relief reported a decline of one-

third in expenditure for this form of relief. The drastic cuts in April relief in many cities were a measure not of the reduction in need but of exhaustion of relief resources. Between April and May the decline was less sharp, in general, than between March and April.

A comparison of the expenditures for relief during March, the peak month of the present year, with such expenditures during March, 1929, shows for 809 agencies in 96 cities an increase of 670 per cent in the outlay for relief over the predepression figure. The amounts coming from private funds and public taxation are as follows:

Amounts expended from public funds and from private funds for family relief by 809 agencies in 96 cities during March, in 1929, 1930, 1931, and 1932, and percentage change

Source of relief	Amounts expended during—				Per cent increase over March, 1929		
	March, 1929	March, 1930	March, 1931	March, 1932	March, 1930	March, 1931	March, 1932
Total	$3,605,733	$5,305,482	$16,090,691	$27,759,935	47	336	670
Public funds	2,719,833	4,201,187	10,043,582	19,224,088	54	269	607
Private funds	885,900	1,104,295	6,047,109	8,535,847	25	583	864

State aid for unemployment relief.

Prior to the present depression, public relief was considered a local function, and few States had assumed any responsibility for assistance to the indigent. A few States, chiefly in New England, had for many years provided for indigent nonresidents because local communities were not legally liable for their support. Massachusetts, for example, for more than a century has given aid to dependent poor persons having no legal settlement in the Commonwealth and no legal claim to relief from the funds of the towns.

In 1931 and 1932, as local resources approached exhaustion because of the unprecedented and growing burden of unemployment, eight States—Illinois, New Jersey, New York, Ohio, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, Rhode Island, and Wisconsin—passed legislation providing State aid to local communities for relief purposes, and three other States—California, Maryland, and New Hampshire—made small amounts available. In response to many requests, a chart summarizing the provisions of this legislation was prepared by the Children's Bureau. Constitutional limitations affecting State and local relief funds were also assembled and analyzed.

Safeguarding child health through planning relief budgets.

In the early winter of 1931 reports came that many private and public relief agencies, both in cities and in rural districts, were being forced by limited financial resources to curtail weekly or monthly relief grants to families. Some relief agencies had continued to give, without regard to the size of the family or the food requirements of its members, the small monthly or quarterly dole of $2, $5, $8, or $10, which before the depression was considered supplementary to the assistance that relatives were able to give.

In order to make easily accessible information about the amount and the cost of the essential protective foods, a folder giving these facts was prepared by the director of the child-hygiene division of the Children's Bureau with the assistance of the Bureau of Home Economics of the Department of Agriculture and the director of the social-service division of the Children's Bureau. A one-page dodger for mothers, entitled "How to Spend Your Food Money," for distribution by relief agencies, was also published. Approximately 75,000 copies of the folder, Emergency Food Relief and Child Health, and 125,000 copies of the dodger had been distributed by the Children's Bureau at the end of the fiscal year under review.

Unemployment relief in areas of extreme depression.

In last year's report reference was made to the fact that at the request of the President's Emergency Committee for Employment surveys of the extent of the need and the available resources for local relief were made in certain coal-mining counties in Pennsylvania, West Virginia, and Kentucky. During the past year coal-mining counties in the following States were included in the survey: Alabama, Arkansas, Illinois, Indiana, Kansas, Missouri, Oklahoma, and Tennessee. Communities in the lumber areas of Michigan and Mississippi were also visited. The counties selected in all these States were, in general, those in which unemployment had been reported to be especially serious and relief inadequate, although there were other counties in each State in which there was little reason to believe that conditions were much better.

The information which formed the basis of the report submitted to the President's committee by the bureau was obtained by interviews with public and private relief officials, superintendents of mines, union officials, school principals and teachers, health officers, priests and ministers of local churches, the neighborhood grocers and milk companies, and anyone else who could give information as to conditions among the unemployed. As the first draft of the report for each State was prepared, it was made available promptly to the President's committee and to State welfare officials, chairmen of State employment committees, and executives of private agencies who were interested in relieving conditions and expressed a desire to see the reports.

The county studies presented variations of the same story of general unemployment and underemployment, of reluctance of the miners to report their need of assistance, of quite inadequate resources for public aid, of private relief agencies unable to meet the needs of those who were dependent in the cities or largest towns and able to give little or no assistance to the small mining towns or camps.[2] Undernourishment among children was widespread. In many communities the school principals and teachers had taken the leadership in organizing some relief for the children. Out of their own salaries and such other contributions as they were able to collect, lunches had been provided at many schools, and the teachers were also collecting and distributing clothing.

[2] No detailed reports of these surveys have been published. A limited number of reprints of an article entitled "Improvement in Rural Public Relief; the Lesson of the Coal-Mining Communities," by Grace Abbott, which appeared in the Social Service Review for June, 1932, is available for distribution.

In the autumn of 1931 the American Friends (Quakers) Service Committee undertook to provide food and clothing for children and clothes and garden seeds for adults in a number of coal-mining communities. They were enabled to do this through a grant of $225,000 by the American Relief Administration and through contributions of clothing, food, and money by members of the organization and interested individuals and firms. At the request of this committee the Children's Bureau lent the services of two members of its staff for limited periods to assist in getting the work started. By March, 1932, the Friends were feeding approximately 24,000 school children in 6 States and furnishing milk to 3,174 preschool children and expectant mothers; the largest number of children being fed through the public schools between September, 1931, and August, 1932, was 40,000, living in 38 counties of Maryland, Kentucky, Tennessee, Illinois, Pennsylvania, and West Virginia. Everywhere the addition of carefully selected lunches served to the school children resulted in prompt improvement in their appearance and mental alertness, and the morale of the miners was greatly strengthened by the interest and assistance of the Friends. Early in July, because of exhaustion of funds, the child-feeding program was given up, except for the distribution of such supplies as were already on hand. At no time, the Friends report, were they able, in cooperation with existing local agencies, to meet even the most pressing needs of the unemployed miners' families. State and Federal assistance were needed to provide immediate relief and to work out some plan for the reemployment of the fathers of these children.

Transient boys.

Inquiries as to the numbers of boys under 21 who were leaving their homes and "hitch-hiking" or, more frequently, "riding the freights," presumably in search of employment not to be found in their own communities, led the Children's Bureau in the spring of 1932 to make brief surveys of the situation. Information was assembled through correspondence with chiefs of police and executives of community chests or councils of social agencies in 25 cities in different parts of the country, and through visits to certain points in the Middle West, South, and Far West. Communities visited for the purpose of the inquiry included St. Louis, East St. Louis, Kansas City, St. Joseph, Memphis, Birmingham, New Orleans, El Paso, and points in Oklahoma, New Mexico, Arizona, Utah, and California. The survey was begun toward the end of March, but an effort was made to procure data for the five months ended February 29. Where that was not possible, current figures were sought.

The findings of the survey were presented informally to a "steering committee" composed of representatives of national agencies interested in the transient problem, which was organized by the National Association of Travelers Aid Societies and had been requested by the President's Organization on Unemployment Relief to assume special responsibility for developing plans for the care of transients. The facts and the conclusions as to methods of preventing the boys from leaving home and giving adequate care to those who had already become transients were also presented to the President's Organization on Unemployment Relief.

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Case-work agencies were already aware of the almost complete breakdown of approved methods of handling transients, built up painstakingly during the years just preceding the depression. Communities did not have the funds to pay transportation of transients to the place of established responsibility. Many communities lacked even the resources necessary to maintain transients while investigation was being made in a distant area. Hence there was a widespread relapse into the practice of "passing on." At the same time the numbers of wandering families, unattached men and women, and boys and girls vastly exceeded those of former years. And the make-up of the groups had changed radically. The traditional single transient of earlier years was the seasonal laborer, the "knight of the road," commonly called the hobo, and the occasional runaway boy or adventurous youth. During the winter and spring of 1931–32 young men and boys who would normally be at work or in school were found to predominate.

Though few exact figures are available, a considerable amount of evidence as to numbers on the road now and during the past winter has been collected. The following items give glimpses of the situation revealed by the mass of data accumulated:

In autumn, winter, and spring the migratory army of men and boys moves toward Florida, the Gulf States, the Southwest, and California. From first-hand observers, from local police, and from special agents and other employees of the railroads, estimates were assembled that seemed to indicate a problem entirely beyond the knowledge of most of the country's social workers. Railroad police in many localities were unable to keep the men and boys off the freight trains. Along the route of the Southern Pacific many small towns in Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona reported the daily passing of about 200 men and boys during the winter and spring. The Santa Fe at Albuquerque averaged 75 a day. From September 1, 1931, to April 30, 1932, the Southern Pacific, with 9,130 miles of track, recorded 416,915 trespassers ejected. This figure contains some duplications, as a man might be ejected at more than one terminal. But it also probably falls short of the total, since, as all railroad police testify, not all those who beat their way on freights come to the attention of the officers. In Kansas City in May railroad men reported that a conservative estimate of the men and boys "riding the freights" through the city at that time was 1,500 per day. In general the estimates as to the proportion of these freight riders who were under 21 were around 20 to 25 per cent. This is borne out by sample counts in localities where ages were recorded.

The men in charge of plant-quarantine stations on the principal highways entering California made some actual sample counts of hitch-hiking boys under 21 entering that State during April and May. The number averaged about 150 per week at each of three points.

In Phoenix, Ariz., during the three and a half months ended April 4, 1932, the Volunteers of America report feeding and lodging 1,529 different boys under 21. Phoenix is on branch lines of the railroads. Yuma, which is on the main Southern Pacific line, reported feeding approximately 30,000 men and boys at its "soup

kitchen" from November 1 to March 15. At least one-fifth were reported as under 21.

Most of the communities through which these transients passed were unable to meet the needs of their own unemployed adequately. They had no choice but to spend as little as possible on nonresidents. Therefore, in city after city the transient boy found that if he paused to seek food or to rest he could remain but 24 hours. The local agency charged with service to transients will usually give him lodging for one night and two meals. Then he must "move on." In the urban centers the time limit was sometimes a little longer. But in the whole mass of evidence assembled, the policy of keeping these wanderers moving was the rule. Shelter facilities range all the way from a basement jail devoid of sanitary arrangements or from permission to sleep in the sand house on railroad property, where the warmed sand lends some degree of comfort on a frosty night, up to a well-regulated lodging house, with beds equipped with fresh linen, and with bathing arrangements and a place to launder soiled clothing. Coffee, bread, beans, and an occasional vegetable stew constitute the menu at station after station. In a very few places where there has been an understanding of food values a more varied diet has been supplied at the same cost.

The transient boys come from practically every State in the Union. The Community Boys' Lodge in Los Angeles reported the place of residence of 623 boys who applied for shelter there in the five months ended March 31. Forty-five States and the District of Columbia had contributed to this group. Of the 1,529 boys served by the Volunteers of America in Phoenix more than 50 had come from each of the following States: California, Colorado, Illinois, Michigan, Missouri, New York, Ohio, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, and Texas, and 25 to 50 boys had come from each of 12 additional States.

Social workers, police, and railroad men, who are in constant touch with these transient boys, assert their belief that the overwhelming majority of them would normally be in school or at work; that they are "on the road" because there is nothing else to do; that they are, on the whole, not of the habitual "hobo" or criminal type.

A check of 5,438 transient men and boys served by the Salvation Army in Atlanta during four winter months showed that 194 had been in college and 1,641 had attended high school.

The boys suffer more than the demoralization which comes from insanitary living conditions, inadequate food, and the irresponsibility of life on the road. Last winter in one western city 35 young men and boys were removed from box cars, seriously ill, some in an advanced stage of pneumonia. As freight yards are policed, trains must be boarded outside the yard limits while the train is in motion. One railroad alone reported more than 50 young men and boys killed and more than 100 crippled in this way last winter. It is no longer possible to pick up odd jobs here and there. Communities jealously reserve even the occasional short-time job for local residents. Therefore the unwelcome nonresident boy either must depend on the bread line or soup kitchen, or must beg or steal. In the box cars, in the "jungles" (as the camping sites adjacent to the railroad yards are called), or even in the municipal shelters, the breakdown of the boys' standards is hastened by the demoralized individuals who seek to prey upon them.

To check this movement the home community must know the problem. Prompt and adequate relief for the unemployed is a first essential. Boys from unemployed families will be driven to the road in communities that provide no relief or relief that is hopelessly inadequate. The boy's desire to decrease by one the number of hungry mouths to feed will be urgent if he sees younger brothers and sisters without enough to eat. On the road are many boys who feel too proud to remain in the community where, for the first time, their families are reduced to accepting community aid.

But even if relief is adequate and skillfully administered, the problem will not be entirely solved. The morale of energetic boys will sink to a low ebb during long periods of enforced idleness. Never before have communities faced such a challenge to use to the utmost their existing facilities in order that they may offer to their restless boys and young men the opportunity for activities that seem to them worth while. Last winter some of the California counties established camps in which forestry activities were carried on. In other parts of the country reforestation of abandoned farm areas or agricultural projects with subsistence for cooperative units in view, might save these boys. Each community can best analyze its own needs and its own possibilities.

But the fact must be faced that again this year, despite all efforts of a preventive character, many boys will take to the road, and these should be protected from as many of the physical and moral hazards of the life as possible. In general, within a local community, protective action for transients should take the form of provision for (1) shelter and food of acceptable standards, (2) registration and interviewing, and (3) a training program to provide for those who can not be sent home and who should not be passed on.

As these transients are not legal residents, the local communities have no legal responsibility for their support, but sympathy for the transients and enlightened self-interest have induced many communities to expend considerable funds in their care. Repressive measures, they realize, are wholly impractical. So far as the Federal Government is concerned, it is generally agreed, even by those who regard this as a national problem to whose solution the National Government should contribute, that the Federal Government should not undertake to care for the transients directly; that is, Federal training camps or Federal relief stations should not be established. Such financial assistance as it gives should be administered through State and local public agencies. Encouragement by the Federal Government of constructive provision for prevention and treatment can come through an educational program or financial assistance for sound plans developed by local communities. This would give free scope for local initiative in working out plans that would utilize local resources and at the same time would make possible refusal to aid plans that seemed likely to aggravate the situation. In general, during this emergency, assistance in a program providing for shelter and food for transients, registration and interviewing, and practical training facilities would be socially economical and justified because these transients have in most States no legal claim on the local community in which they happen to be, and have sometimes lost their eligibility for legal relief in the home community, but they are United States citizens. While no community looks upon the prob-

lem from a narrow legalistic attitude, the transient is an outsider and his needs are secondary. The size of the problem requires State and National cooperation.

RESEARCH AND GENERAL EDUCATIONAL WORK IN MATERNAL AND CHILD HEALTH

Causes of maternal mortality.

The report of the study of maternal deaths in 15 States, made in cooperation with the State boards of health and State medical societies, was reviewed in great detail by individual members of the bureau's obstetrical advisory committee, and was considered at a 3-day meeting of the committee held in January, 1932. Because of the great value of the material the committee recommended further statistical analysis of a number of points, and the publication not only of the detailed technical report of interest to obstetricians but also of a condensed report for more general use. Revision of the detailed report is nearing completion.

Survey of infant and maternal mortality in New Orleans.

A survey of the unusually high infant and maternal mortality in New Orleans has been undertaken in collaboration with the New Orleans Parish Medical Society, the departments of pediatrics and obstetrics of Tulane and Dillard Universities, the Child Welfare Association, the city board of health, the Touro Infirmary, and other agencies. Interest has been focused on the relation of the death rates to such factors as age, race, hospitalization, preventive care, attendant at birth, and district of the city in which the deaths occurred. Statistical analysis is being made of the infant mortality rates for children born in New Orleans during 1930 (the most recent year for which complete birth and death data are available) and of the maternal mortality rates for 1929, 1930, and 1931. A survey of the facilities available in New Orleans for the care of infants and young children and for maternal care is being made by physicians of the bureau staff, and the report will cover all agencies and institutions which offer facilities for preventive as well as curative care. In addition, the bureau's consultant in obstetrics has investigated currently the maternal deaths occurring in the city during the calendar year 1932 and reported the findings to a committee of the New Orleans Parish Medical Society. It is the purpose of this committee to study the data presented and to decide as far as possible whether or not the deaths should be considered as preventable.

County organization for infant and prenatal work.

Visits have been made by the director of the maternity and infant hygiene division of the bureau to 30 counties in Georgia, Kentucky, Michigan, Mississippi, New York, and North Carolina that have full-time county or district health organizations to observe their child-health work, particularly their maternity and infancy work. In general, the work for mothers and young children was found less developed than the health work for school children. In many of the counties the maternal-health work is limited to the prenatal and postnatal visits which a nurse performing a generalized service is able to give. In approximately half of the 30 counties good medical supervision was available for infant and preschool children in the child-

health centers. Only two of the counties visited (Cattaraugus County and Westchester County, N. Y.) have organized divisions of child hygiene with medical directors. In these, and in some of the Michigan counties in which the Michigan Children's Fund has assisted in the development of the work, comprehensive programs are being developed.

Institutes and courses for doctors.

Short, intensive courses in obstetrics (given on request of State departments of health and county medical societies) for doctors in active practice, carried on for two years through the cooperation of the medical school of Emory University in Atlanta, Ga., were extended during the past year to rural communities in Kentucky and Mississippi. Courses are scheduled for New Hampshire, and work is to be completed in Mississippi and Kentucky during the present fiscal year.

Neonatal morbidity and mortality.

Analysis of material collected in the New Haven study of neonatal morbidity and mortality has continued. Because prematurity is the chief cause of neonatal deaths a special study of the care given premature infants in a number of communities is being made, 91 hospitals in 22 cities having been visited during the past year. The object of this study is to determine: (1) The provision made in hospitals for the care of premature infants and the type of care given; (2) the mortality from prematurity. It is well known that the smaller the premature baby the less the chance of survival, so that total mortality figures (usually the only ones available) are not so valuable as figures compiled by weight groups. Therefore, the cooperation of the hospitals visited has been sought in compiling mortality figures in four groups according to weight at birth.

New Haven rickets studies.

Work has continued on the organization and analysis of material secured through the bureau's 3-year demonstration in the prevention of rickets. During the past year two special projects in connection with studies of rickets in New Haven have been undertaken.

Effect of antirachitic treatment in infancy on skeletal and tooth development.—Selected groups of children who had been examined as infants or young children in the bureau's earlier investigations of the prevention and control of rickets were studied to discover the results of antirachitic measures used in infancy and the ultimate effect of the severer degrees of rickets on skeletal and tooth structures. Two groups of children, now ranging in age from 6 to 13 years, were selected for such follow-up examinations: (1) Children given antirachitic treatment in infancy and known to have had little or no evidence of rickets either by Röntgen ray or by clinical examination during the first year or two of life; (2) children given no planned antirachitic treatment and known to have had at least moderate rickets (some of them severe rickets) at some time during their first three or four years of life. Weight and various skeletal dimensions were taken in each case, and special study was made of bony deformities that might be ascribed to previous rickets. A detailed examination of the teeth was made in each case by dentists from the Yale University School of Medicine, and in a large number of cases

molds of the teeth and dental arches were taken from which stone casts have been made.

Salmon oil in the treatment of rickets.—During the winter and early spring of 1932 there was carried out in New Haven a special investigation of the value of salmon oil in the treatment of infantile rickets. In September, 1931, Tolle and Nelson [3] had reported from the United States Bureau of Fisheries and the United States Bureau of Chemistry and Soils that oil prepared from the waste products of certain species of salmon was twice as potent a source of the antirachitic vitamin as was a good grade of cod-liver oil used for comparison in their biological assays, and they estimated that there was a potential supply of salmon oil amounting to approximately 1,000,000 gallons a year going to waste in the salmon-canning industry. Because of the great need of cheap sources of the antirachitic vitamin for infants and young children, especially in the present period of economic depression, and the widespread need for emergency food relief, it seemed urgent that this hitherto untapped source should be made available, provided that clinical tests corroborated the results of the laboratory tests.

Clinical tests were undertaken, therefore, and 13 children with active rickets were treated with salmon oil prepared from the waste product of three species of salmon. Each sample of oil was found to have a very prompt antirachitic effect, as shown by clinical, Röntgen-ray, and blood-chemistry tests. In addition, biological assays of the samples of salmon oil used in the clinical studies have been made in the Bureau of Chemistry and Soils, which is collaborating in the study.

If the quantity of salmon oil potentially available in the salmon-canning industry were to be put on the market as a properly standardized food and supplied at low cost through the usual channels for distribution of food, one of the great nutritional needs of children would be more easily and more adequately met.

Children excluded from school because of venereal disease.

During the year the bureau undertook a short study, in cooperation with the Social Hygiene Society of the District of Columbia, of the problem of the exclusion of children from schools in the District because of venereal disease in an infectious stage. Reports indicated that such exclusion was often for relatively long periods; for example, it was stated in a recent health and hospital survey made of Washington under the auspices of the Washington Council of Social Agencies that 21 of 43 children under treatment at the social-hygiene clinic of the District Department of Health on a given day had been excluded from school for one to four years. The purpose of the bureau's study was to determine, if possible, the actual extent of the problem, so that the results might be used as a basis for constructive planning for these children from the educational and social, as well as medical, point of view.

Three hundred and twenty-one children were listed as excluded from school because of venereal disease by four agencies whose records were checked in detail. The duration of school exclusions for

[3] Tolle, C. D., and E. M. Nelson Salmon Oil and Canned Salmon as Sources of Vitamins A and D. Industrial and Engineering Chemistry, vol. 23, No. 9 (September, 1931), pp. 1066–1069.

this reason among children of compulsory school attendance age in the District was found to have been less than had previously been estimated. For the most part the children excluded from school for long periods were in institutions where full-time or part-time school work was available. However, the average period of exclusion of a group of children out of school for this reason at the time the study was made was between five and six months—a period sufficiently prolonged to make some educational provision for them desirable. The report will be available in the near future, and it is hoped it will contribute to the development of a coordinated program for the care and education of these children.

Infant death rates.

The infant mortality rate for the expanding United States birth-registration area was 68 per 1,000 live births in 1929, 65 in 1930, and 62 in 1931, according to the United States Bureau of the Census. The 1931 rate is provisional; it does not include Utah, for which figures are not yet available. It is probable, however, that, as in previous years, the final 1931 rate for the birth-registration area will not be significantly different from the provisional one. The following nations had a lower death rate in recent years than the provisional United States rate of 62 for 1931: New Zealand (32), Australia (47), Switzerland (49), Netherlands (50), Sweden (54), and Norway (55).[4] England and Wales, with a rate of 66 in 1931, as compared with 60 in 1930, had a higher rate than the United States. When figures are available for all countries for 1931 the United States will probably maintain the position it has had for several years—seventh among the nations for which comparable figures are available. Among the States, Iowa established a new low record with 40 deaths per 1,000 live births in 1931; Oregon (44), Washington (48), Kansas (48), and Nebraska (49) were the other States with rates below 50.

The trend of infant mortality in the United States from 1915 to 1930 was definitely downward, the average annual rate of decrease amounting to 3.1 per cent. The expected rate for 1931 on the basis of the 1915–1930 experience would therefore be between 67 and 55. The provisional rate, 62, is within these limits of expectation; the reduction is slight when the decline during 1915–1930 is considered but important in view of prevailing economic conditions.

Attention has been called in previous reports to the fact that there was a rapid decrease in rates in the early years of the birth-registration area when the number of States was constantly increasing and registration of births was growing more common throughout the country. A comparison of 1931 with a constant area during a period when birth and death registration were well established gives a better picture of the progress that has been made. In the United States birth-registration area as of 1921, exclusive of South Carolina,[5] the average annual rate of change from 1921 to 1930 was a decrease of more than 2 per cent, a significant downward trend. On the basis of this experience a rate for 1931 between 66 and 58 was to be expected

[4] The figures quoted are for 1931 with the exception of that for Norway, which is for 1929, and those for Australia and Sweden, which are for 1930.
[5] The 1921 area included Utah, for which 1931 figures are not yet available.

for this area. The provisional rate for 1931, exclusive of Utah, is 62 and within these limits.

The latest figures giving infant mortality rates by cause of death are for 1929. In the 1921 registration area referred to, during the period 1921–1929, there is a statistically significant downward trend in infant mortality amounting on the average to 2 per cent annually. In the rates from natal and prenatal causes the decrease was about 1 per cent each year, in epidemic and communicable diseases about 4 per cent, and in gastrointestinal conditions 8 per cent. The mortality from natal and prenatal causes reflects the prenatal care the mother receives and the care for both mother and baby at the time of childbirth as well as the neonatal care of the baby. Popular education as to the importance of breast feeding, the proper care of milk, the preparation of simple formulas, the introduction into the infant's dietary of the right foods at the right time, as well as the value of sunshine, fresh air, and good routine in the care of the baby, explain the large reduction in deaths due to gastrointestinal causes. Unquestionably this popular education has proved its value and should be continued.

Although infant mortality rates continue to be favorable in comparison with previous years, and there have been no serious epidemics, reports have come to the Children's Bureau from communities and agencies of different types indicating the toll of the depression in terms of the health of the children.

Indications of potential effects of the depression on the health of children are found in evidence that amounts of relief being given to needy families in many places fall below what is considered the minimum required, on the basis of present prices, to provide the food essential for the health and growth of children. The consumption of milk, the most important single food in the diet of children, is known to have decreased in certain communities in New York, Illinois, Pennsylvania, and West Virginia. A large number of health officers recently have reported cuts in their budgets and have stated that child welfare and public-health nursing are most often affected by these reductions.

That these phenomena carry serious implications was recently well expressed by Dr. William H. Welch:

> Too great economy as far as health is concerned, because of the current depression, is particularly dangerous to the welfare of growing children. Undernourishment of children, for example, is not likely to show itself immediately but is bound to show its effects later, when it is probably too late to remedy. The ground lost by undernourishment in childhood may never be regained.

These conditions can be combatted only by increased vigilance on the part of health and social agencies and the determination of the public that permanent losses to children must be prevented.

Maternal death rates.

Maternal mortality rates for 1930 have just become available. The rate for the expanding birth-registration area was 67 per 10,000 live births in 1930, as compared with 70 in 1929, which was the highest rate for any year since 1915, except 1918 to 1920, when influenza was an important contributing cause of death among mothers. In the birth-registration area during the period 1915–1930 the maternal

mortality rates showed neither definite upward nor definite downward tendency but varied considerably from year to year.

The increase in the number of States in the registration area and the variation in the completeness of registration of both births and deaths have influenced the maternal mortality rates. For determining the progress made in reducing maternal deaths, as in reducing infant deaths, the rates for the birth-registration area as of 1921 exclusive of South Carolina may be used. The expected rate for 1930, on the basis of the 1921–1929 experience, was between 64 and 61. The 1930 rate for this area was 62, which is well within the limits of expectation.

Mortality rates for the period 1921 to 1930 are available for Denmark, England and Wales, New Zealand, Scotland, Sweden, and Switzerland. For all these countries, except Scotland, the maternal death rate was considerably lower than for the United States. Much encouragement, however, can be derived from the fact that in the United States and Switzerland the maternal mortality rates show a significant decrease during this period. In Switzerland the average annual rate of decrease during these years amounted to 2 per cent, that of the United States (for the birth-registration area as of 1921) to 1 per cent. No upward nor downward tendency sufficient to be statistically significant appears in the rates of Denmark, New Zealand, and Scotland. In England and Wales and in Sweden the trend of maternal mortality was definitely upward. The rates for England and Wales increased on the average 2 per cent annually, for Sweden 3 per cent.

The only cause of maternal death in the United States for which 1930 figures are available is puerperal septicemia. In the 1921 area referred to, the rates from this cause decreased from 1921 to 1930 on the average 1 per cent per annum. The lowest rate for puerperal septicemia (22.6 per 10,000 live births) was recorded in 1930. Although more than 36 per cent of the deaths of mothers, even with this new low rate, were due to puerperal septicemia, a cause recognized as largely preventable by asepsis, it is encouraging to find that the trend is now downward.

The development of widespread medical interest in attacking the problems of maternal mortality and maternal care is undoubtedly a factor in the improvement which has been noted. State medical societies cooperated in the detailed study of maternal deaths made in 15 States during the last two years of the operation of the maternity and infancy act, and subsequent studies of a similar nature have been undertaken by a number of medical societies and city, county, and State health departments in their own localities, using the same schedule that was devised for the larger study. The White House Conference on Child Health and Protection has published a committee report containing a frank account of the failings of obstetric education in this country and recommendations for its improvement. Large attendance is reported at graduate courses in obstetrics which have been offered to physicians by State boards of health and county medical societies in a number of places. State boards of health have continued their efforts to train midwives in places where the midwife still exists.

It is to be hoped that the efforts of the doctors for the improvement of obstetric education will continue and expand. A lowered mater-

nal mortality rate will be the inevitable result of such efforts. At the same time one must not lose sight of the value of popular education as to the importance of adequate prenatal and obstetrical care. The fact that during the period 1921 to 1929 there was a significant downward tendency of about 2 per cent a year in the deaths due to albuminuria and convulsions, which may largely be prevented by prenatal care, would seem to indicate that popular education in this respect is bringing results.

Recent surveys show, however, that even now the great majority of women do not receive such care, and it is of great importance that facilities for education in maternal health should be increased.

Popular bulletins on child health.

Infant Care, which was completely rewritten in 1929, was again revised in part so as to incorporate the most recent and authoritative information. With the same purpose, two of the popular folders were issued in completely revised form—Why Drink Milk? (No. 3) and Sunlight for Babies (No. 5). A similar revision of Folder No. 8, Breast Feeding, was in press at the close of the year. The bulletin on child management is being revised. A leaflet on posture training for children and a list of references for parents on child care are in preparation. Dr. Douglas A. Thom, the author of Child Management, has prepared new material on the problems of the adolescent child, which will be published during the coming year.

EXTENT OF ASSISTANCE GRANTED UNDER MOTHERS' AID LAWS

Preliminary findings are available of a questionnaire study as to the extent to which aid for mothers with dependent children was actually granted during the year ended June 30, 1931, in the 44 States—and the District of Columbia—which had had mothers' aid laws during the entire year. Twenty-seven States cooperated with the bureau by compiling the statistics for the State; the bureau obtained information directly from the counties in 17 States.

Information as to whether aid was granted was obtained for towns and cities in the New England States and for all but 266 of the 2,727 counties or cities administering these laws in the other States. Definite statements were received that no mothers' aid was given in 909 counties and cities, and in another 83 counties the figures indicated that poor relief rather than mothers' aid was given. The majority of the counties and cities for which no information was available or which reported that no aid was given were in eight States (Arkansas, Kentucky, Louisiana, Mississippi, Missouri, Tennessee, Texas, and Virginia), in which as few as 1 per cent to 17 per cent of the counties were granting mothers' aid.

Ten years ago approximately 121,000 children were receiving aid in the 40 States that then had mothers' aid laws. In 1931 reports for the 44 States and the District of Columbia which were granting aid on June 30, 1931, show that approximately 250,000 children were receiving this form of assistance in their own homes. The increase of more than 100 per cent in the number of children receiving this type of aid is not explained by the addition of four States—Kentucky, Mississippi, North Carolina, and Rhode Island—and the District of Columbia, which have passed mothers' aid laws since 1922,

as only 3,824 children were receiving aid in 1931 in these States. Most of the acts passed are permissive to the counties, but even in States passing mandatory laws the counties have been slow in making the necessary appropriations except in the larger urban centers. Additions to the number of counties and towns granting aid in the States where mothers' aid legislation antedated 1922, increased appropriations making it possible to reduce or wipe out waiting lists, better administrative policies, growth in population, and movement of population to the larger urban areas where mothers' aid was being granted have all contributed to the increase in the number of children receiving this form of public assistance.

The number of families aided per 10,000 population varied in the States that were granting aid in the majority of the counties from 1.5 in North Carolina to 24 in Wisconsin. The average number for the 44 States and the District of Columbia was 10 families and 28 children, the average number of children per family aided being 2.7. The numbers aided reflect not the local differences in the number of families eligible under the law but the extent to which the appropriation makes it possible to aid all those legally entitled to assistance. Standards of administration also are a factor in the character of investigation made and public appreciation of needs.

The total amount reported as paid to mothers' aid families during the year 1931 throughout the country was approximately $35,000,000. This sum, which does not include administrative costs, represented an average annual per capita expenditure, for the population in the area granting mothers' aid, of 40 cents. Per capita expenditures in the reporting areas in different States varied from 3 cents in North Carolina to 82 cents in New York. Much variation existed also in the per capita expenditures in different counties, even those within the same States; an extreme example is 3 cents in the county including Indianapolis and $1.16 in New York City.

For the United States as a whole the average monthly grant per family was $32.80, but in the States it varied from $6.83 in Arkansas to $69.31 in Massachusetts. The average grant per family paid in the large cities or in counties including such cities was, with a few notable exceptions, much more uniform. It was also larger, averaging $45.82 a month.

Information as to the reasons for giving aid was obtained for about two-thirds of the families. In 82 per cent of these families the father was dead; in 5 per cent he had deserted the mother; in 2 per cent the parents were divorced; in 3 per cent the father was in prison, in 4 per cent physically disabled, and in 3 per cent mentally disabled. While in a number of States the law limits this form of aid to children whose mothers are widows, in the 10 States and the District of Columbia in which, under the statutes, aid may be granted to any needy mother, the percentage of aid for children whose mothers were widows varied from 54 in Washington to 94 in New Hampshire.

Few of the published reports of agencies administering mothers' aid give any information as to race of the families receiving aid. Although information as to the race of the mother aided was requested, information was obtained from all the jurisdictions in only a few States. Of the total number of mothers for whom this infor-

mation was reported (46,328), 96 per cent were white, 3 per cent were negro, and less than 1 per cent belonged to other races.

The number of negro families aided was reported by the administrative agency in 45 large cities. In 25 of these the percentage of negroes in the total families aided was the same as or larger than the percentage of negroes in the total population of the city or county. In 12 cities the number of negro families receiving aid was small in proportion to the number in the total population, and in 8 cities no negroes were aided. Among the 20 cities where little provision had been made for negro families were 8 in which more than 10 per cent of the population were negroes. Three of these cities—Indianapolis, Ind.; Memphis, Tenn.; and Houston, Tex.—had given no aid to negro families, and five—Wilmington, Del.; Miami, Jacksonville, and Tampa, Fla.; and Knoxville, Tenn.—had aided the children of only a few families.

PREVENTION AND TREATMENT OF DELINQUENCY

Recreation.

For the last four years the recreation specialist of the bureau has given most of her time to furthering recreational programs in rural districts. This work has been done in cooperation with the extension divisions of the Federal and State departments of agriculture and has reached many groups of older boys and girls and women and a number of mixed groups of men and women in a large number of States.

During the last year there has been a noticeable increase in the numbers of adult groups seeking advice and assistance in planning for leisure-time activities and social life for their communities. Incomes in rural areas have been materially reduced, and in many localities various forms of entertainment and cultural activities previously brought to the community from other places have been discontinued.

Institutional treatment for delinquent boys.

The study of the results of institutional treatment for delinquent boys, to which reference has been made in other annual reports, has continued. In the year under review case histories were secured for 308 boys who have been discharged from parole for at least five years from the State training schools for delinquent boys in Ohio and New York. This brings the total number of boys for whom information was sought in the course of this study to 773. They came from State schools in five States—California, Michigan, New Jersey, New York, and Ohio. Of the 773, 624 boys (81 per cent) were personally interviewed by agents of the bureau and for 81 boys whose whereabouts was unknown, considerable information was obtained from agencies and relatives; 32 were not interviewed because too distant; 21 had died; and for 15 no information was found.

The five institutions were visited, and careful study was made of their physical equipment and of their programs with reference to education, recreation, trade training, and physical care. An attempt will be made to relate the school-training programs to some of the factors which contributed to the subsequent success or failure of the

boys. The descriptive study of the institutions will be published as Part I of the report. The case material, which will throw much light on the problems the boys encountered after they left the institution, as well as on the value of the institutional training they received, is being prepared for tabulation and final analysis and will be published as Part II of the final report.

Probation and the prevention of delinquency.

Using social experimentation as the method of study, the development and use of resources for preventing or treating delinquents by the probation officer has been made one of the major undertakings in the delinquency field. A district in southwest Chicago has been selected, and the demonstration will be the joint undertaking of the Children's Bureau and the Juvenile Court of Cook County, and the School of Social Service Administration and the university clinics of the University of Chicago. For the project the services of a psychiatrist who has had much experience with children of school age have been made available by a joint arrangement between the Children's Bureau and the University of Chicago. The university is also making available the services of a psychologist, and a member of the faculty of the School of Social Service Administration of the university who has specialized in home and school relationship will give much time to the general direction of the demonstration. The Children's Bureau is providing a psychiatric social worker, a specialist in recreation, and an office secretary. The work will be along two general lines: (1) Supervision of individual delinquent children referred by the juvenile court or of children presenting special conduct problems referred by schools and other neighborhood agencies; and (2) development of community resources that will help to prevent delinquency and to improve the administration of laws designed for the protection of young persons.

Cooperation with the Department of Justice in provision for Federal juvenile offenders.

Considerable progress has been made in a program for constructive treatment of the Federal juvenile offender. It was more than 10 years ago that a report of a survey made by the Children's Bureau of the numbers, ages, offenses, and treatment of children brought before the Federal courts for violation of some Federal statute was published.[6] Since that time the numbers of such offenders have been considerably increased as a result of the Dyer and Volstead Acts, but the method of criminal procedure and the unsatisfactory institutional-commitment policy remained practically the same, as the report of the National Commission on Law Observance and Enforcement shows.[7]

Since the reorganization of its Bureau of Prisons the Department of Justice has given special consideration to the problem of how these juvenile offenders against Federal laws may be as constructively cared for as are the offenders against State laws in States in which the juvenile court and its auxiliary services and resources for treatment are well developed. With the cooperation of the Chil-

[6] The Federal Courts and the Delinquent Child. United States Children's Bureau Publication No. 103. Washington, 1922.

[7] Report on the Child Offender in the Federal System of Justice, pp. 2–4, 59. National Committee on Law Observance and Enforcement Report No. 6. Washington, 1931.

dren's Bureau, the situation has been discussed with juvenile-court judges and leading experts in the field. The conclusions reached are that the causes of Federal delinquency, whether community or personal, are the same as those the State juvenile courts are attempting to treat; whether the child comes in conflict with a Federal or a State law is largely accidental; cure rather than punishment is the objective, and this is primarily a community problem; finally, the small number of juvenile offenders against Federal laws in proportion to their wide geographical distribution makes the setting up of Federal juvenile courts and special Federal agencies for the care of these children impractical.

In a circular issued August 14, 1931, the Attorney General announced as his policy that "wherever practicable and consistent with the due enforcement of Federal statutes, juvenile delinquents who come into Federal custody will promptly be returned to the communities from which they come, for care and supervision or punishment by the State authorities." This administrative policy has now been confirmed by act of Congress of June 11, 1932 (Public No. 169, 72d Congress). Under this law, for the purpose of cooperating with the States in the care and treatment of juvenile offenders, United States attorneys are authorized to forego prosecution of any person under 21 years of age if he is subject to the laws of a State that can and will assume jurisdiction, and if investigation shows such surrender is to the best interests of the United States and of the juvenile offender. The law authorizes payment by the Federal Government of the cost of transporting the juvenile to his home community.

To assist the Bureau of Prisons in the practical working out of this program, the Attorney General requested, through the Secretary of Labor, the cooperation of the Children's Bureau. Because of its long interest in these children, the Children's Bureau was glad to undertake a part of the work involved in the development of this new program. It has undertaken (1) to investigate and report to the Department of Justice, to United States district attorneys, and to courts and probation officers regarding State facilities (institutions, courts, and detention homes) for the care of delinquents; (2) to assist in bringing together State and Federal officials in promoting better care for Federal delinquents.

The Children's Bureau was fortunate to secure as a result of civil-service examination the judge of one of the leading juvenile courts of the South for consultant on the Federal juvenile offenders. One of the Children's Bureau investigators who has been at work on the study of institutions for delinquent boys will give full time to the Federal-offender program during the next year, and two other staff members who have been specializing in delinquency problems will give part time to it.

In connection with the cooperative program 18 State institutions for delinquents were visited during the past year by members of the staff of the Children's Bureau, and reports have been submitted to the Department of Justice. In a number of these institutions Federal juvenile offenders are being cared for under contract with the Federal Government. Cooperation between Federal and local authorities has been worked out through visits to three States—North Carolina, Georgia, and Alabama. A series of meetings to discuss

the program of the Department of Justice and the Children's Bureau was held in Philadelphia in May, during the National Conference of Social Work. At these meetings representatives of State departments of public welfare and of juvenile courts expressed enthusiasm for the policies being developed and willingness to accept responsibility for the care of their own children when referred by Federal authorities. Widespread interest in the subject has been manifested by agencies such as State bar associations, law schools, legal journals, and the American Legion, as well as social-work agencies.

Popular bulletin on juvenile delinquency.

In response to many requests for a brief summary of the report of the committee on delinquency of the White House Conference and other recent reports, a short bulletin entitled "Facts About Juvenile Delinquency; Its Prevention and Treatment" has been prepared. This will make readily available recent material on this subject for those who are interested in a community program.

COOPERATION WITH STATE, COUNTY, AND INSULAR PUBLIC-WELFARE AGENCIES

The bureau's specialist in public-welfare organization is unable to accede to all the official requests for her services. During the summer of 1931 she prepared a report of a survey of public child-welfare resources in Iowa, and with the director of the social-service division of the bureau she attended a conference of public and private agencies interested in the child-welfare work of the State to discuss the findings and plans for future work. At the request of the Kansas Public Welfare Commission she went to that State to discuss a survey of its child-welfare needs which the commission is undertaking. At the request of the New Jersey State Commissioner of Institutions and Agencies she was released to the pension-survey commission of the State for the month of December to assist in working out a plan for reorganizing the child-welfare activities which have been a joint responsibility of the State and local public agencies.

The study of the child-welfare functions and administrative procedure of State departments was interrupted because of the loan to the Association of Public Welfare Officials of the person who had been making the study. However, several visits were made to the States in connection with this study, and the field work has been practically completed. There are many requests for this material, and it is hoped the report can be completed this year.

Another member of the bureau staff who made the studies of the mining communities and assisted the Friends in getting their school feeding program under way has been assisting the Department of Public Welfare of West Virginia in connection with the assistance the State is planning for local relief agencies.

At the request of the governor the bureau sent an expert in child-welfare administration to Puerto Rico during the fiscal year 1931 to make a study of the care of dependent and neglected children. In the autumn of 1931 the governor and the insular child-welfare board requested a continuation of the bureau's consultation and advisory service. A specialist in child dependency was sent by the bureau in November to work for five months with the insular child-

welfare board. This board, created by the legislature in 1925, is charged with the responsibility of studying all problems affecting childhood, proposing revisions in child-welfare legislation, and inspecting child-welfare institutions and schools for dependent and delinquent children. In April, 1931, the board was provided with funds for the employment of a trained social worker as executive secretary, and a second social worker was detailed by the department of health. The bureau's representative assisted in developing a program for the insular board which includes the organization and supervision of local child-welfare committees appointed by and responsible to it; supervision of public and private institutions and foster homes, and consultation service to these agencies; investigation of admissions and discharges to insular institutions; studies of special problems; and compilation and study of legislation.

A study of pending applications and of the population of the two insular institutions for dependent children (the boys' and girls' charity schools) brought out the fact that many of these children might have been cared for in their own homes or in homes of relatives if counsel and advice in planning, and in some cases financial aid, had been given. In order to make such assistance available, it was decided to organize local child-welfare committees. Two were functioning by the end of the year—one in Ponce and one in San Juan. Committees of the insular board carried on important studies, organized groups to consider and formulate standards of foster-home and institutional care, and developed a plan for social investigation and group discussion of all cases recommended for discharge from the charity schools. The board plans to continue the general program outlined during the coming year and has requested further assistance from the Children's Bureau.

INDUSTRIAL HAZARDS AFFECTING WORKING MINORS

Regulation of the employment of minors in hazardous occupations.

The report of the White House Conference on Child Labor contains the following statement and recommendation made by the subcommittee on child labor and approved by Section III of the conference at the November meetings in 1930:

> Our present body of knowledge of the hazards of the industries and occupations minors are employed in is so fragmentary and incomplete that it does not furnish a scientific basis upon which adequate protective measures for minors may be worked out. Because of this fact and because State legislation on the subject has been formulated with little reference to modern industrial conditions and with little consideration of even such knowledge of occupational hazards as is available, the protection from industrial hazards afforded young workers is uneven and inadequate. It is therefore strongly recommended that such legislation be revised on the basis of a careful and comprehensive study both of occupations in which minors are engaged and of those in which industrial accidents occur, as well as of possible safeguards in such occupations. Attention should be directed particularly to any special susceptibility of immature workers to industrial poisons and other harmful substances. As the problem affects working minors throughout the entire country, it is recommended that a permanent committee be appointed to work in cooperation with the Children's Bureau in studying all phases of the problem.[8]

In accordance with this recommendation, the Children's Bureau organized a committee of experts on the regulation of the employ-

[8] Child Labor; report of the subcommittee on child labor of the White House Conference on Child Health and Protection, pp. 317, 318. New York, 1932.

ment of minors in hazardous occupations. This committee, which had its first meeting in Washington, D. C., in May, 1932, consists of the four members of the White House Conference subcommittee which considered the industrial hazards to which working minors are exposed, together with leading safety engineers, industrial hygienists, and specialists in the field of enforcement of workmen's compensation and child labor laws.

Information as to special hazards for minors, statistics of accidents to minors, and the extent of legal restrictions on their employment in hazardous occupations was collected by the bureau for the use of the committee. The committee's report, which is soon to be published, lists the occupations and places of employment from which, on the basis of existing evidence, the committee believes minors under specified ages should be excluded because of accident hazards or danger to health and also outlines certain general standards and procedures to promote better enforcement of legislation enacted. The committee will continue to assemble information on this general problem, and as new factual material becomes available or as industrial processes change it will amplify or revise its recommendations.

Workmen's compensation laws and the illegally employed minor.

The study of illegally employed minors as affected by workmen's compensation laws, under way at the end of the previous fiscal year, was completed and is now in press. It analyzes the provisions of the laws affecting such minors and their interpretation by State administrative agencies and by the courts, and presents such evidence as could be found of the comparative benefits available to injured minors under different types of laws.

EMPLOYED BOYS AND GIRLS IN ROCHESTER AND UTICA, N. Y.

An analysis of the employment histories of 4,852 young workers in Rochester and Utica was completed during the year. This is the third in a series of studies of young workers undertaken to show what the vocational opportunities were for children who left school at an early age for work. The kinds of occupations open to them, their wages, the stability of their employment, the influence of their school training and ages on their occupations, wages, and regularity of work were points on which information was especially sought. This study, as well as the preceding ones in this series, made in Newark and Paterson, N. J., and in Milwaukee, was carried on before the onset of the present industrial depression, so that the facts obtained reflect work opportunities under relatively normal business conditions.

More than one-third of the Rochester children and more than two-fifths of the Utica children who had been employed had left school at 14 years of age or younger, and most of the others in each city at 15 years. However, 63 per cent of the boys and 54 per cent of the girls in Rochester, and 41 per cent of the boys and 30 per cent of the girls in Utica had continued to attend school after they met the age and educational requirements of the New York law with reference to work permits.

The occupations of the children in these two New York cities, like those of the children in Newark and Paterson and in Milwaukee,

were chiefly in the manufacturing, mercantile, and clerical occupations for which little skill or training is required. At the time the study was made 52 per cent of the Rochester boys and 43 per cent of the girls were employed in manufacturing and mechanical occupations, the girls chiefly as factory operatives, the boys as helpers in building and other trades as well as in factories. In Utica, where there are large knitting mills, a much larger proportion of the girls than of the boys were employed in factories.

Nearly two-fifths of the Rochester boys had taken special or vocational training in industrial subjects in school, but at the time the children were interviewed this training had influenced but little the kinds of work in which they had found employment. However, all the children were still under 17 years of age, and the industrial courses offered boys in school were principally for certain of the building trades, carpentry, electrical construction, or for skilled occupations in the metal trades, as toolmaking, patternmaking, and drafting, in which work opportunities for boys under 17 are limited. Only 10 per cent of the boys who were 16 at the time of the study were holding jobs as learners in any trade.

Evidence was found that the school grade completed by the Rochester boys did not especially affect the kind of work they obtained, but the grade completed by the girls did influence their occupations. Many of the girls from the high-school grades, a group that included girls with commercial training, were clerical workers, telephone operators, salesgirls, and errand workers in stores; a larger proportion of those from the elementary grades entered factories and domestic occupations. In Utica, however, where but few children had completed as much as one year of high school, little association was found between school accomplishment and occupation.

CURRENT STATISTICS IN CHILD WELFARE AND RELATED FIELDS

The Children's Bureau has three projects for promoting uniform reporting of statistics relating to children and child welfare. In 1920 it began to assemble and analyze reports on the issuance of work permits as a means of providing current information regarding the number of children receiving official permission to leave school for work. In 1927 it began to assemble reports from juvenile courts and to work out with the courts uniform practices in defining and recording cases, so that comparable delinquency trends would be available. Finally, in 1930, it took over the project for current reporting in selected metropolitan areas in some 22 fields. While the bureau has had to begin with reports from individual cities or counties in most States, state-wide reporting through the appropriate State department is recognized as the objective and is being promoted as rapidly as the State organization and the development of standards in the reporting of the various fields makes general reporting practical. These three projects are briefly discussed below.

Reports for the metropolitan registration area for current social statistics.

The Children's Bureau has been engaged actively during the last two years in the development of the current reporting of local social statistics and centralized tabulation and analysis. Such a plan is necessary to provide for information as to significant national and local trends in the social and health services in child welfare and re-

lated fields. This activity of the bureau is a continuation of a project for the registration of social statistics in metropolitan areas started by the National Association of Community Chests and Councils and developed in cooperation with the local community research committee of the University of Chicago from 1926 until transferred to the Children's Bureau on July 1, 1930.

During the past year the number of areas reporting to the bureau was increased from 38 to 41 through the inclusion of three areas in which reporting had been brought to a satisfactory standard of completeness during a year's probationary period. Three additional areas are being given special service in establishing their reporting procedures in preparation for inclusion in 1933.

The cities at present included in the social-statistics project are as follows:

Akron, Ohio.
Berkeley, Calif.
Bridgeport, Conn.
Buffalo, N. Y.
Canton, Ohio.
Chicago, Ill.
Cincinnati, Ohio.
Cleveland, Ohio.
Columbus, Ohio.
Dayton, Ohio.
Denver, Colo.
Des Moines, Iowa.
Detroit, Mich.
Duluth, Minn.
Grand Rapids, Mich.
Harrisburg, Pa.
Hartford, Conn.
Indianapolis, Ind.
Kansas City, Mo.
Lancaster, Pa.
Louisville, Ky.
Milwaukee, Wis.
Minneapolis, Minn.
Newark, N. J.
New Haven, Conn.
New Orleans, La.
Norfolk, Va.
Omaha, Nebr.
The Oranges, N. J.
Pittsburgh, Pa.
Richmond, Va.
Sharon, Pa.
Sioux City, Iowa.
Springfield, Ill.
Springfield, Mass.
St. Louis, Mo.
St. Paul, Minn.
Syracuse, N. Y.
Washington, D. C.
Wichita, Kans.
Wilkes-Barre, Pa.

The total population of these cities is 15 per cent of the total population and about 30 per cent of the urban population of the United States.

The reports received by the bureau each month cover 22 fields of social and health service and come from 2,167 cooperating agencies through supervisors appointed in each area to take charge of local collection and forwarding. In most areas the supervisor is a member of the staff of the community chest or the council of social agencies.

Many of the reports deal with the care of dependent and neglected children. Of the 2,951 separate reports received, 612 are from institutions and case-work agencies organized for such service. Day nurseries and maternity homes furnish 264 reports. Another large group of reports gives information on trends in family-welfare service and relief, including various types of special assistance, such as mothers' aid, aid for the blind, and work relief. These reports form 473 of the total.

Through the monthly reports from the registration areas on relief expenditures and cases, as well as the special aid for the transient and homeless, much of the information used in the study of relief trends during the depression in cities of 50,000 population and over has been secured. This has already been briefly discussed. (See p. 1.)

Economic conditions are reflected in social-statistics reports of other agencies. While less striking than the changes in the cost and volume of relief work, the differences in certain other services are of great importance. For example, the percentage of days' care to free cases in 71 hospitals and related institutions in 10 areas was 52.2 in the calendar year 1931, in comparison with 46 in 1930 and

42.8 in 1929. Fifteen visiting-nurse associations in 14 areas reported that 58.3 per cent of their visits in 1931 were to free cases; in 1930 the percentage of free visits was 54.4 and in 1929, 52.7. Reports show that dependence upon clinics for medical and dental care has increased steadily, with recent indication of a tendency toward a lessened rate of increase that appears to be caused primarily by the curtailment of clinic service by agencies operating under reduced budgets.

A larger number of dependent and neglected children are being cared for each year in foster homes on a boarding basis, but the volume of free care in foster homes is slightly below that reported for 1929. The number of dependent and neglected children in institutions has remained relatively unchanged. For 10 areas, approximately complete reports on the care of children in institutions and foster homes have been filed each month since 1929. On the last day of May, 1932, the number of children being boarded in foster homes was 7,087, in comparison with 6,440 on the same day in 1931, 5,787 in 1930, and 4,946 in 1929. Children in free foster homes numbered 1,812 on the last day of May, 1932, 1,844 in 1931, 1,822 in 1930, and 2,014 in 1929. Institutional residents were 7,926 in 1932, 7,767 in 1931, 7,766 in 1930, and 7,841 in 1929.

The care of children in day nurseries has diminished. For a group of 108 agencies in 26 reporting areas, the average number of children registered on the last day of the month was 5,746 in 1929. In 1930 there was a drop to an average of 5,592 under care in the same agencies, and in 1931 a further drop to 5,152. For the first five months of 1932 the average is 4,766.

Annual summaries for these and other fields of social and health service have been published or are in preparation for 1930, and progress has been made in the tabulation and preliminary analysis of data for 1931 and the early part of 1932.

Planographed compilations of data in the monthly reports continued to be forwarded to cooperating agencies for the period through December, 1931. Because of the expense involved in preparation and distribution, this type of monthly summary has been discontinued on recommendation of the bureau's advisory committee on social statistics, and a brief news bulletin is being issued in its place during the current fiscal year. This bulletin will contain each month analyses of data in fields not covered by the bureau's monthly relief bulletin and also news items of interest in connection with the registration of social statistics.

An important phase of the social-registration project since its organization in 1926 has been the formulation of specific recommendations on the items which should be included in monthly reports in the different fields of service and the preparation and distribution of report forms and detailed instructions for their use.

A handbook on public health nursing statistics, in preparation during several years by a joint committee representing the bureau's advisory committee on social statistics and the National Organization for Public Health Nursing, was completed and is in press. A handbook on medical social-service statistics, previously issued in mimeographed form, was revised and will soon be ready for printing.

Problems arising in the reporting of legal-aid statistics have been considered during the year by a newly organized committee with

membership representing the National Association of Legal Aid Organizations. The bureau's committee on child-welfare statistics has been enlarged, and intensive work by this committee is being planned for the coming year.

Much remains to be done before the collection of social statistics, under the plan now in operation by the bureau, will give essential data for the accurate measurement of trends in the social and health fields in different sections of the country and in different types of communities. The statistics being assembled as yet relate only to the large cities and the near-by areas covered by the same welfare services and give little basis for conclusions as to the nature of important changes in welfare services in small cities and in rural areas. Adoption of a uniform plan of reporting involves careful study of the relative values of current practices in different fields of welfare service and much educational work to secure the use of the recommended plan in the preparation of agency reports. Definite progress in securing uniform reporting has been made during the past year, and further intensive work along this line is planned.

Juvenile-court statistics.

The Children's Bureau has continued to receive regular reports from juvenile courts. For the calendar year 1931 reports of cases of children dealt with by the juvenile courts were received from all the courts in two States (Connecticut and Utah) and from 71 courts in 21 other States and the District of Columbia. The State of Connecticut was added to the reporting area, and several other changes occurred in the list of cooperating courts. Five courts serving areas with more than 100,000 population and 3 serving a somewhat smaller group were added, and 18 courts serving areas with smaller populations discontinued reporting. These changes are in accord with the program of the Children's Bureau to encourage state-wide reporting through a State agency, usually in the case of juvenile-court statistics the department of public welfare, and to continue to develop the reporting to the bureau of individual cases only from courts serving large urban communities.

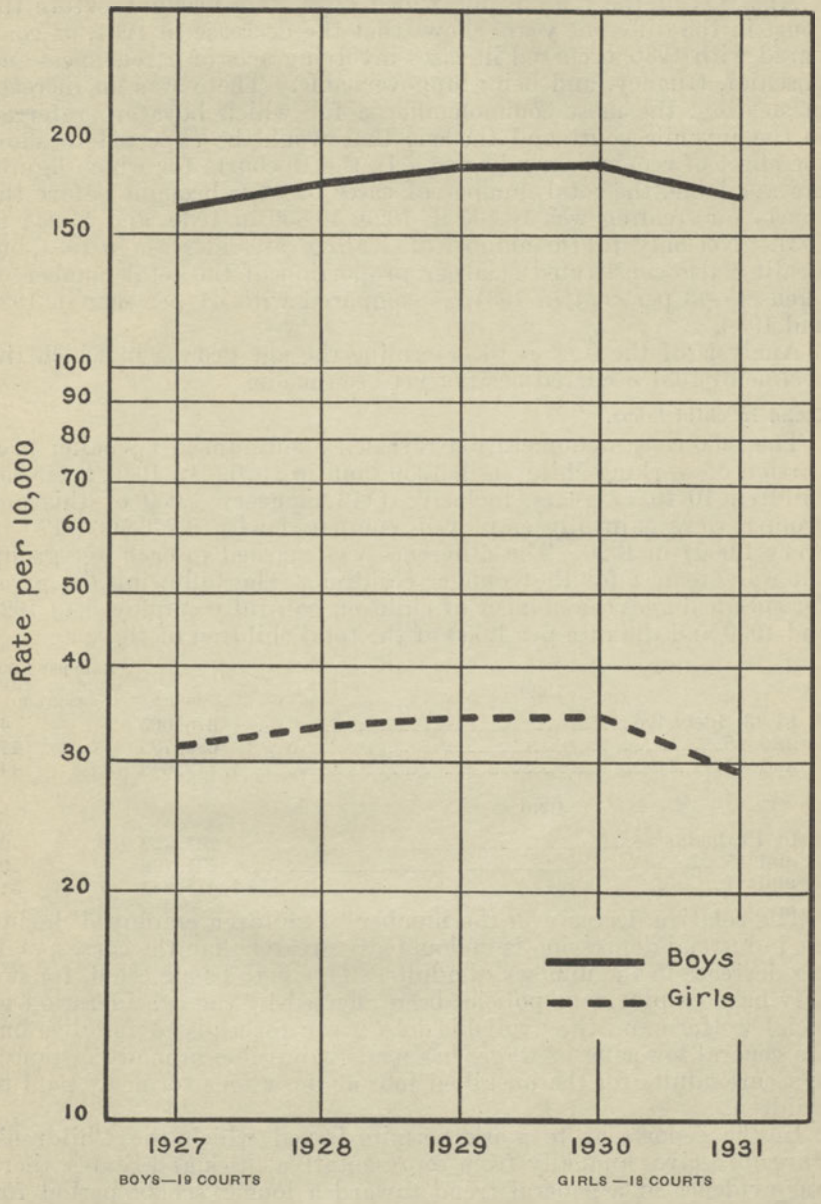
The courts now reporting to the bureau serve about 22 per cent of the population of the United States. During 1931 they submitted facts regarding 59,439 delinquency cases, 22,317 dependency and neglect cases, and 1,116 cases of other types over which the courts had jurisdiction, and 17,356 cases of children who had been discharged from supervision after a period of probation or supervision.

Nineteen large courts have reported to the bureau ever since the effort to promote uniform statistics was begun in 1927. During this 5-year period progress has been made toward uniformity, and it is possible to reach some conclusions as to the trend in delinquency rates from these courts.

As the accompanying diagram shows, the trend of the rates for boys from 1927 to 1930 was upward, but in each year of this period the percentage increase was less. The 1928 increase over 1927 was 8 per cent, the 1929 increase over 1928 was 5 per cent, and the 1930 increase over 1929 was only 1 per cent. This slowing up in the percentage increase to a point where it is negligible between 1929 and 1930 was followed by a definite drop in the rate in 1931, which amounts to 8 per cent decrease from the preceding year. In the delinquency rates for girls the same general tendency is apparent.

JUVENILE-DELINQUENCY RATES FOR BOYS AND GIRLS DEALT WITH BY LARGE COURTS REPORTING THROUGHOUT THE PERIOD 1927–1931

RATES PER 10,000 CHILDREN OF THE SAME SEX OF JUVENILE COURT AGE JURISDICTION



There was an upward trend from 1927 to 1929; the 1930 rate was the same as that of 1929; and the 1931 rate definitely lower than that of 1930.

Analysis of the reasons for which boys were brought before the court in the different years shows that the decrease in 1931, as compared with 1930, occurred in cases involving acts of carelessness and mischief, truancy, and being ungovernable. There was an increase in stealing, the most common offense for which boys are referred to the juvenile court and the one that would be expected to show the effect of economic conditions. In the 19 courts for which figures are available, the total number of cases of boys brought before the courts for stealing was 10,105 in 1929, 10,850 in 1930, and 11,244 in 1931. Not only did the number of stealing cases increase in 1931, but stealing also constituted a larger proportion of the total number of offenses—43 per cent in 1931, as compared with 41 per cent in 1929 and 1930.

Analysis of the figures to determine the age groups in which the decline of 1931 occurred has not yet been made.

Trend in child labor.

The 1930 census enumeration revealed a substantially smaller proportion of working children in 1930 than in 1920. In 1930, 2,145,959 children 10 to 17 years, inclusive (113 in every 1,000 of this age group), were gainfully employed, compared with 2,773,506 (170 in every 1,000) in 1920. The difference was marked in each age group but was greatest for the younger children. The following list gives for specified ages the number of children gainfully employed in 1920 and 1930 and the rate per 1,000 of the total children of these ages:

	Number	Rate per 1,000 children of the age group
1920		
10 to 13, inclusive	378,063	44
14 and 15	682,795	175
16 and 17	1,712,648	447
1930		
10 to 13, inclusive	235,328	24
14 and 15	431,790	92
16 and 17	1,478,841	317

The relative decrease in the number of children employed during the industrial depression is undoubtedly greater than the corresponding decrease in the number of adults. This is to be expected, for not only have employment policies been affected by the consideration of social welfare and the available jobs given to heads of families but the general lowering of wages has made it possible in many instances to secure adults for the unskilled jobs at the wages formerly paid to children.

In the reports as to work permits issued which the Children's Bureau receives annually from representative cities and States, there was evidence of a general trend toward a longer school period for children and the postponement of entrance into industry to the age of 16 years. It was noted in the Annual Report of the Children's Bureau for 1931 that a considerable increase in the number of work permits issued during the first months of 1929 was followed by a decline in the last months of the year. That general decline has continued. Its dependence in large measure upon decreased em-

ployment opportunities for children is doubtless the explanation of the irregularity of the decline from city to city and from State to State. Where child-employing industries are still actively functioning, the decrease in the number of children going to work has been relatively small. In fact, there is evidence that in some localities the depression has brought new demands for child labor.

Recent reports from a number of employment offices indicate that the largest opening for minors is in domestic service, and demands in this field are increasing rather than decreasing. As many of the States and cities reporting do not certificate for domestic service, the increase in the employment of children in this field is not fully reflected in the records of work permits issued.

Except so far as the decline in child labor is due to the strengthening of child labor and school attendance laws, it can not be considered as permanent. The number of children employed still depends to a very large extent upon the demand for child labor and the laws regulating employment. With increase in employment opportunities, children will doubtless be again drawn into industry in large numbers unless the State legislatures raise the school-leaving age.

Reports as to the number of first regular work permits issued in the calendar year 1931 were received from the following: State-wide reports for 23 States, and reports from 36 cities of 50,000 or more population in 11 other States, and from the District of Columbia. These reports showed 78,859 children 14 and 15 years of age who went to work for the first time during the year 1931. An examination of the individual reports shows decreased employment in 1931 as compared with 1930, ranging from 7 per cent in New Jersey to 61 per cent in Tennessee in the States reporting state-wide figures and among the cities reporting, from 15 per cent in Providence, R. I., to 83 per cent in Springfield, Ill. Increases reported in two States—Connecticut and Oregon—may be accounted for by changes in methods of certification. On the other hand, a few cities in these States showed increases which apparently reflect a greater demand for cheap labor in these particular areas.

Information as to certificates issued to minors 16 and 17 years of age was received for 5 States, 34 cities in 7 other States, and the District of Columbia, which reported a total of 55,735 minors of these ages going to work. In the District of Columbia and five States for which comparable statistics were available for 1930 and 1931 the decrease was 16 per cent. Seven cities (four of them in one State) reported increases in the number of young people of this age entering employment in 1931, ranging from 2 to 74 per cent.

As in the previous year, about one-third of the children who went to work before they were 16 started while they were still 14 years of age. An important factor in determining whether children go to work at 14 or at 15 years of age is the educational standard which under the law a child must meet before obtaining a certificate. State-wide and city reports for States in which the child labor law required the completion of the eighth grade before a child of 14 was permitted to obtain a regular-employment certificate showed 21 per cent of the children receiving certificates were 14 years of age; in States where the law required the completion of the eighth grade with exemptions, 24 per cent were 14 years old. On the other hand,

in the States requiring less than the completion of the eighth grade for 14-year-old children a much higher percentage (50 per cent) of the children were 14 years of age when they went to work in 1931.

The usual educational requirement for employment certificates is the completion of a specified grade, ranging from the fourth to the eighth. In the whole group of States and cities which have reported grade completed for each of the past five years the percentage of children 14 and 15 years of age who have completed the eighth or a higher grade has increased from 59 in 1927 to 64 in 1931. In every year, however, wide variations are found between States and even between cities in the same State. In 1931, in the States giving statewide figures and the cities in other States where more than 200 children received certificates, the percentage who had advanced at least as far as completion of the eighth grade ranged from 17 to 100; and the percentage who had completed no grade beyond the sixth varied from 0 to 62.

Analysis of these reports as to work permits issued, usually included in the annual report of the chief, will be published this year in the December number of the Monthly Labor Review of the Bureau of Labor Statistics. Reprints will be available for school and labor officials and others especially interested in child labor.

LEGISLATION AFFECTING CHILD WELFARE[9]

During the past fiscal year regular legislative sessions were held in nine States: Kentucky, Louisiana, Massachusetts, Mississippi, New Jersey, New York, Rhode Island, South Carolina, and Virginia. Eighteen State legislatures met in special session. Inasmuch as the major issues in the large majority of these States were relief of unemployment and curtailment of expenditures, few measures relating to other subjects of social welfare became laws.

Seven States—Illinois, New Jersey, New York, Ohio, Pennsylvania, Rhode Island, and Wisconsin—passed measures authorizing State aid for relief to families and individuals to meet needs growing out of the unemployment emergency.

Illinois created an emergency relief commission, with full discretion in distribution of relief funds and authority to cooperate with relief agencies. A special property tax to yield $25,000,000 and tax-anticipation notes to the amount of $18,750,000 were authorized. The tax was not to be collected, however, if a proposed $20,000,000 bond issue was ratified at the coming election.

New Jersey created a State emergency relief administration with an appropriation of $8,000,000 for municipal home relief and work relief and $1,616,033.50 for county work relief. The money was originally appropriated to reimburse local subdivisions for a specified part of their relief expenditure, but an act effective July 1, 1932, removed limitations on the use of funds and gave the State director of emergency relief complete authority for their distribution. An act providing for a $20,000,000 bond issue to provide additional relief funds is to be submitted to the voters in November.

[9] A fuller summary of child-welfare legislation in mimeographed form is available on request.

A State temporary emergency relief administration was provided for by the New York Legislature, which appropriated $25,000,000, parts of the sum to be available for different periods from November 1, 1931, to November 15, 1932, mainly for reimbursement to cities and counties for a specific proportion of their expenditures for home relief, work relief, State improvements, and veterans' relief. A $20,000,000 bond issue to provide additional relief funds available until January 1, 1934, in such amounts as the legislature may determine, will be voted on in November. If the bond issue is approved, $15,000,000 will be available for the period from November 15, 1932, to February 1, 1933.

Ohio placed administration of its relief funds in a State relief commission. Counties and cities, to which the gasoline and motor vehicle license taxes (estimated to produce $9,000,000 in 1932) are allotted under existing law, were authorized to use these funds for relief. In addition, counties were authorized to issue bonds to provide relief funds, to be repaid through new utility taxes (estimated to produce $13,000,000 in 1932).

Pennsylvania appropriated $10,000,000 to the department of welfare for home relief. (A new law was passed on August 19, 1932, appropriating an additional $12,000,000 for work relief and home relief. Administration was placed in a State emergency relief board.)

Rhode Island authorized towns and cities to issue notes to procure funds for unemployment relief (work relief, if available) and appropriated $2,500,000 for the purchase of these notes by the State. The notes may be financed by municipal bond issues to be repaid through new taxes.

Wisconsin appropriated for relief the entire proceeds from an emergency tax on incomes—approximately 100 per cent more than the former rate—and from the chain store license fees levied for two years. Most of the amount, estimated at $7,000,000 for 1932, is for outdoor poor relief, to be administered by the State industrial commission; $500,000 is for emergency forestry work, to be administered by the State conservation commission.

Little legislation affecting children in industry was enacted. So far as available information indicates, the year may be characterized from the standpoint of child-labor standards as one of considerable effort but slight advance. Several attempts to break down present standards were unsuccessful.

Significant progress, on the other hand, was made in Louisiana. An educational requirement was set up for the first time for the child going to work—sixth grade or eight years' school attendance in New Orleans—and provision was made in New Orleans for a vocational counselor to give guidance to children leaving school for work and a safety engineer to inspect places of employment and require safe conditions for workers. Legislation also was enacted providing for the establishment of continuation schools in certain places for employed children and requiring their attendance. New Jersey authorized the commissioner of labor to determine what occupations are hazardous for minors under 18 and prohibited their employment in such occupations. Kentucky authorized a survey of

public education and required that every common-school district receiving aid from public taxation provide schools for the minimum legal school term.

Among social-welfare measures enacted during the year were the Kentucky law creating a State department of public welfare, to which were transferred all the powers and duties formerly vested in the State board of charities and corrections and in the commissioner of institutions; the Rhode Island law establishing a bureau of probation, parole, and criminal statistics under the direction of the State public-welfare commission; the revision of the New Jersey laws relating to mothers' aid and the care of dependent children to remove the maximum limitation on relief grants and liberalize the eligibility requirements for mothers' aid, so as to make possible the transfer of a large number of children from the dependency division to the mothers' aid division of the State board of children's guardians; and the first appropriation by the State of Virginia for mothers' aid.

STATE CHILD-WELFARE COMMISSIONS

State commissions interested in improving legislation relating to child welfare or social welfare have reported activity during the past year in Connecticut, Illinois, Kansas, New Jersey, and Oregon. The New Jersey Pension Survey Commission drew up and recommended five bills relating to dependent children, all of which became law. In the other States the legislatures did not meet in regular session in 1932, but the commissions have been making studies and laying plans for the coming year. Massachusetts passed three of the bills that had been recommended by its children's commission in 1931. The Alaska Child Welfare Commission also has been preparing information for a report to the 1933 session of the legislature.

PUBLICATIONS ISSUED, IN PRESS, AND IN PREPARATION

During the fiscal year 1932, 24 new and 3 revised publications were issued, in addition to 18 issues of planographed tables in the field of social statistics. Twelve publications were in press at the close of the fiscal year.

Reports issued:

Nineteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1931.
The Child from One to Six; his care and training (revised January, 1931). Publication No. 30.
Infant Care. Revised 1932. Publication No. 8.
Child Welfare in Selected Counties in Washington. Publication No. 206.
Leisure-Time Activities of Rural Children in Selected Areas of West Virginia, by Ella Gardner and Caroline E. Legg. Publication No. 208.
Social statistics in child welfare and related fields:
Annual reports for the registration area for the year 1930, by Glenn Steele:
Care of Children in Day Nurseries.
Family Welfare (including Mothers' Aid and Veterans' Aid).
Legal Aid.
Number of Aged in Public and in Private Institutions. [Reprinted from Monthly Labor Review (February, 1932) of the Bureau of Labor Statistics.]
Protective Case Work for Young People and Maternity Homes.
Temporary Shelter for Homeless or Transient Persons and Travelers Aid.

Reports issued—Continued.

Social statistics in child welfare and related fields—Continued.

Current monthly reports and special articles on registration-area findings:

Current Statistics in Child Welfare and Related Fields (monthly tables, 10 issues).

Relief Statistics (January–April, 1931; April–June, 1931; May–July, 1931; January–September, 1931; calendar year 1931; Monthly Relief Bulletins for January, February, and March, 1932).

Juvenile-Court Statistics, 1929; annual report based on information supplied by 96 courts. Publication No. 207.

First Regular Employment Certificates Issued to Working Children in 1930. Separate from Nineteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1931. 10 planographed tables added.

Employment of Mentally Deficient Boys and Girls, by Alice Channing. Publication No. 210.

Folders, leaflets, and reprints of articles issued:

Emergency Food Relief and Child Health.

How to Spend Your Food Money.

Sunlight for Babies. Revised. Folder No. 5.

Why Drink Milk? Revised. Folder No. 3.

Community Care for Dependent, Delinquent, and Handicapped Children. Revised. Folder No. 7.

Constitutional Limitations Affecting State and Local Relief Funds, by Carl A. Heisterman. [Reprinted from the Social Service Review, vol. 6, No. 1 (March, 1932).]

The Child during 1932, by Grace Abbott. [Reprinted from the American Journal of Sociology, vol. 37, No. 6 (May, 1932).]

Improvement in Rural Public Relief; the lesson of the coal-mining communities, by Grace Abbott. [Reprinted from the Social Service Review, vol. 6, No. 2 (June, 1932).]

A Ten-Year Child-Welfare Plan, by Grace Abbott. [Reprinted from the Parents' Magazine (May, 1932).]

A Year's Expenditures of Ten Railroad Laborers, by Helen Russell Wright. [Reprinted from the Social Service Review, vol. 6, No. 1 (March, 1932).]

Review of White House Conference Report on Child Labor, by Ella Arvilla Merritt. [Reprinted from Monthly Labor Review (June, 1932) of the Bureau of Labor Statistics.]

Vocational-Guidance Recommendations of White House Conference on Child Health and Protection. [Reprinted from Monthly Labor Review (January, 1932) of the Bureau of Labor Statistics.]

List of Publications, January 2, 1932.

Publications and reprints of articles in press:

Breast Feeding. Revised. Folder No. 8.

Make Childbirth Safer.[10] (Reprinted from the Parents' Magazine, June, 1932.)

Facts about Juvenile Delinquency; its prevention and treatment. Publication No. 215.

Care of Dependent and Neglected Children. Separate from Social Statistics in Child Welfare and Related Fields—Annual Report for the Registration Area for the Year 1930 (Publication No. 209).

A Handbook on Records and Statistics in the Field of Public-Health Nursing.

Monthly Relief Bulletin, April, 1932.[11]

News Bulletin on Social Statistics in Child Welfare and Related Fields, July, 1932.[12]

Juvenile-Court Statistics, 1930; annual report based on information supplied by 92 courts. Publication No. 212.[13]

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[10] Issued Aug. 9, 1932.
[11] Issued July 9, 1932.
[12] Issued July 20, 1932.
[13] Issued Aug. 1, 1932.

Publications and reprints of articles in press—Continued.

Child-Labor Recommendations from the Report of the Subcommittee on Child Labor of the White House Conference on Child Health and Protection. (Reprinted by permission of the White House Conference.)
Employed Boys and Girls in Milwaukee. Publication No. 213.
The Illegally Employed Minor and the Workmen's Compensation Law. Publication No. 214.
Welfare of Children of Maintenance-of-Way Employees. Publication No. 211.

Reports in preparation:

Twentieth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1932.
Causes of Maternal Mortality; a study of maternal deaths in 15 States.
A series of reports on the study of rickets in children in New Haven.
Tropical Sunlight and Rickets; a study of the röntgenographic appearance of the bones of normal infants in Puerto Rico, the incidence of rickets, and related socio-economic conditions.
The Status of Care Available for Premature Infants in the United States.
Child Management. Revised. Publication No. 143.
Guiding the Adolescent.
State Departments of Public Welfare, with special reference to child-welfare organization and activities.
The Child, the Family, and the Court; a study of the administration of justice in the field of domestic relations—Part 2, Organization and Administration of Family Courts.
In Place of a Parent; the A B C of foster-family care for children.[14]
Institutional Treatment of Delinquent Boys.
Minnesota Children's Bureau; evaluation of 10 years of work.
Mothers' Aid Manual.
Mothers' Aid in the United States; its development and extent.
Social Statistics in Child Welfare and Related Fields—Annual Report for the Registration Area for the Year 1931.
Juvenile-Court Statistics, 1931.
First Regular Employment Certificates Issued to Working Children in 1931.
Children of Working Mothers in Philadelphia—Part 2.
Employed Boys and Girls in Rochester and Utica, N. Y.
Employment of Minors in Hazardous Occupations.

Folders in preparation:

Books and Pamphlets on Infant and Child Care and Training.
Good Posture in Little Children.

DISTRIBUTION OF PUBLICATIONS

The total number of publications distributed by the bureau in the fiscal year 1932 was 1,826,654, as compared with 1,562,463 in 1930.[15]

The reduction in the bureau's printing allotment under the economy program for the present fiscal year will reduce the number of popular bulletins available for free distribution.

Figures as to the purchase of bureau publications during 1932 are not yet available. There is special interest in the sales of the popular bulletins, which, according to the Superintendent of Documents, were as follows in the fiscal years 1929, 1930, and 1931, and from 1922 through June 30, 1931:

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[14] Originally published by the Pennsylvania Department of Welfare. Revised edition to be issued by the Children's Bureau.

[15] The bureau has record of 1,187,409 publications distributed in 1931; the figure is incomplete because some of the records were destroyed by fire.

Bulletin	1929	1930	1931	1922–1931
Total	372, 233	285, 741	324, 887	2, 314, 283
Prenatal Care	78, 944	53, 271	63, 017	484, 750
Infant Care	168, 569	131, 811	139, 710	1, 045, 236
Child Care [1]	66, 804	37, 782	38, 085	445, 315
Child Management	57, 916	62, 877	65, 257	320, 165
Are You Training Your Child To Be Happy?	----------	----------	[2] 18, 817	18, 817

[1] Superseded in 1931 by The Child from One to Six.
[2] Issued September, 1930.

Purchases of these bulletins in quantities are frequently made by public and private agencies interested in child health. As is to be expected because of general curtailment of budgets, sales in 1930 and 1931 were somewhat smaller than in 1929.

The Child-Welfare News Summary was issued 26 times during the past year and sent to a mailing list of about 1,100 child-welfare agencies and publications and to persons actively engaged in child-welfare work. For reasons of economy it has been found advisable to suspend the regular issuance of the Child-Welfare News Summary during the fiscal year beginning July 1, 1932. A few numbers on special subjects will be issued during the year.

EXHIBITS

During the year 603 shipments of exhibit material, including 1,898 panels, 219 reels of film, 150 slides, 26 film strips, and 81 models, were sent to National, State, and local organizations. For reasons of economy, it has been decided to suspend the bureau's exhibit work during the fiscal year beginning July 1, 1932.

In closing this the twentieth annual report of the Children's Bureau reference must be made to the services of its staff. Throughout its history they have been devoted to its purposes and resourceful and intelligent in the services they have rendered. During the past years the requests made of the bureau for consultation, for assistance in surveys, for studies of some aspect of child welfare or child development have steadily increased. With the emergency requests due to unemployment, it has taken skillful planning and devoted service to keep abreast of the work. Credit for its accomplishments during this emergency must go to the assistant chief, who was acting chief for much of the year, and to the members of the staff.

Record must also be made here of the death of Julia C. Lathrop, chief of the Children's Bureau during its first nine years—from 1912 to 1921. From the beginning Miss Lathrop's program of work for the bureau set up prevention as its goal, although the existing temporary importance of palliatives was not ignored. She held that, as a democracy, the United States must seek ways to insure the optimum growth and development of all American children.

The remarkable series of infant-mortality studies which were planned when Miss Lathrop was chief of the Children's Bureau sought the economic and social, as well as the physical, factors in a

high infant death rate. While evidence was assembled as to the best methods of care of the dependent child, the causes of dependency were not forgotten. The child at home and at school, at work, or at play, in urban or rural environment, the negro child who suffered from the handicap of racial discrimination, the wards of the Nation in our island posesssions, were all included from the beginning in the bureau's plans for discovering and serving the needs of the Nation's children. The slow, scientific accumulation of fundamental, basic information about children and child life was begun in no narrow or timid spirit by Julia Lathrop. She was prepared to go wherever the interests of the child might lead her and to accept whatever conclusions flowed from an honest interpretation of facts assembled with meticulous accuracy. Miss Lathrop resigned as chief of the Children's Bureau in August, 1921, but she was to the end interested and helpful in the development of its work. The Children's Bureau has suffered a great loss in her going.

Child-welfare workers everywhere look to the coming year with much anxiety. It will take great effort to maintain the standards of service for children which were slowly developed during the years before the depression, to make sure that their interests are safeguarded in the general economies which the depression has made necessary. Neglect of the health, education, and general welfare of children will be permanently costly to the children and to the future of the country.

Respectfully submitted.

GRACE ABBOTT, *Chief.*

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